

S P E C T R A V I D E O Users Group (WGTN) ..

NEWSLETTER NUMBER 4 SEPTEMBER 1984

The next meeting is on MONDAY , OCTOBER 15 , at 7.30 in the SEMINAR ROOMS 3,4,5 , Floor D , Wellington Clinical School , Mein Street , Newtown.

The following meeting is on November 19 at the same venue and time

Wellington SpectraVideo Users Group

Secretary .. Don Stanley
c/- Epidemiology Unit
Wellington Hospital
ph 855999x5958 (wk)

Treasurer ... Colin Chin
P.O Box 2197
Wellington

Notes from meeting of 17-9-84

At this meeting attention was drawn to a new SpectraVideo magazine similar to our club newsletters called KIWIMSX. If you want to subscribe to this fill in the enclosed subscription form.

A new manual which has been developed by club members is now available. This manual covers both cassette and disk based BASIC, and is the result of 8 months usage of the systems. A form is enclosed with this newsletter if you want to order a copy of this manual. The manual consists of about 110 pages of single sided A4 paper, we have chosen this format to make it simple for people to insert extra pages if they wish.

Brian Wilson from the Auckland Users Group attended this meeting and made several comments of interest to owners who may be interested in obtaining a modem. The standard SpectraVideo modem is NOT able to be operated in New Zealand, but there is a possibility that a modem which satisfies New Zealand specifications may become available in a few months.

If anyone is interested in obtaining a connector to go between the keyboard and the super expander, about 4 inches long, cost about \$80-90 please contact Don Stanley ASAP. We may be able to get these at a better price if enough people are interested in them.

BASIC NOTES other versions of Basic

I have been asked several times just what difference there is between versions of Basic on other micros and the SV Basic. Here are a few answers and tips for converting other programs to SV Basic.

Any machine which uses BASICA for graphics, eg IBM-PC, SEGA and several others, will cause little difficulty in converting the graphics to SV Basic (WHICH IS NOT MSX). The main problems will be different names for commands, and in the case of the IBM-PC, some extra commands and a slightly more powerful BASICA eg PAINTing in a different colour to the border. Also some of the other machines may have different graphics resolution to the SV, so that some unexpected results/errors may occur if the programs use PSET or LINE etc outside the SV 255x192 pixel matrix.

SEGA Basic is very similar to SV Basic, but PUT SPRITE is just SPRITE, the PATTERN statement in SEGA is equivalent to reading data using the READ and DATA statements, (but note that the PATTERN command allows functions like ASC in the command) SV LOCATE is called CURSOR in the SEGA, the SEGA COLOR command allows an extra parameter to specify which part of the screen to COLOR, and SEGA has statements BLINE, BCIRCLE which seem identical to the SV LINE and CIRCLE commands.

The SEGA uses the TM9929A VDP chip. The SV uses a 9918A chip. For most applications there is little difference, and thus any SEGA graphics program is fairly easily converted.

For machines which don't use BASICA eg the Commodore, my advice would be to steer clear if they use PEEK and POKE at all. Memory organisation in the various machines is quite different, what POKES happily on a COMMODORE may cause a system crash on the SV. Also the ORIC1 and the APPLE BASIC's are generally very different to the SV. Note to that no machine code program from the COMMODORE or APPLE will run on the SV, as they don't use z80.

As far as machine code routines go if it's Z80 assembler it will run on the SV, but you may need to make some changes as memory locations referenced by other machines programs may have completely different meanings in the SV.

Computer Input have a lot of SEGA programs, you should be able to convert them without too much trouble. But note that SEGA uses a different SOUND chip to SV (although the BASIC commands to use sound are the same as SV) so sounds will generally differ from what they are on the SEGA. Also any statements which use I/O ports (eg OUT or IN) will probably need the port locations changed to the SV equivalent. (Also SEGA has no commands like ON SPRITE GOSUB).

The ACT SIRIUS has a similar BASIC with respect to graphics commands, but again, beware of programs which use the higher

resolution than the SV. Also the SPECTRUM is quite different graphics wise, the only commands which I have got to operate on the SV are PLOT x,y which is just PSET (x,y) and DRAWx,y which is LINE -STEP(x,y).

There is no guarantee that any MSX programs will run on the SV, but they shouldn't need too much altering to make them work.

ODDS & ENDS

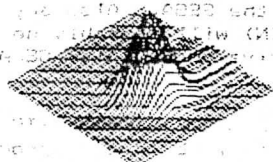
Bits and Bytes magazine want to publish SpectraVideo programs in their magazine. They pay for programs, so if you have programs, even small simple ones contact Darryl Alison ph 399510 for more details.

Members welcome to ... Theo Corfiatis, Steve Currington, Philip Allen, Denis Usherwood, Donald Rogers, Dave Kelly, J H Tuinman, R H Higginson, F Adams, Colin Campbell, Mrs L Lust, John Matthews, Joan and Noel Newlove, P J Plane, Arthur Lloyd, Mike Dalliessi, Michael Wright.

Set and reset Modes again page 7 of the CP/M users guide mentions the escape sequence ESC x to set modes. I have found only one escape sequence which does anything useful, it provides a cursor off/on command for MBASIC or CBASIC or anything else under CP/M.

```
PRINT CHR$(27)+"x"+CHR$(53) to switch cursor off
PRINT CHR$(27)+"y"+CHR$(53) to switch cursor back on
```

Members Discounts ... Moonshine Computers in Lower Hutt and Wellington as well as Einsteins Computers are offering discounts on selected goods to members... enquire at the shops for details. Note that membership cards for paid up members will be mailed out within 2 weeks. Use these cards to verify membership when buying discounted goods from these stores.



BIVARIATE NORMAL DISTRIBUTION
 $x = 0 \quad (0.15) \quad 0$

Further to the note on direct cursor addressing in last months newsletter is the following suggestion from P Plane in Wanganui .

"The cursor locate using the escape sequences can be very effectively used in a user defined function to obtain a LOCATE function in CP/M BASIC as follows ...

```
10 DEMONSTRATION OF CURSOR LOCATION USING USER DEFINED FUNCTION
20 CLS
30 DEF FN L$(X,Y)=CHR$(27)+"Y"+CHR$(32+Y)+CHR$(32+X)
40 PRINT FN L$(20,10),"NEAT HUH"
50 LOCATE 20,10
60 A$=INPUT$(1)
```

In other words everywhere you would normally use LOCATE x,y you use PRINT FN L\$(x,y) instead "

***** FILE ALLOCATION TABLE ERRORS IN DISK BASIC *****

Also from P.J Plane comes this little screen dump program, it is for the SEIKOSHA GP100 printer only and is set up to print only white pixels on any background....

```
10 LPRINT CHR$(8)
20 FOR V=0 TO 27
30   FOR Z=0 TO 255
40     FOR X=0 TO 6
50       IF POINT(Z,X+V*7)=15 THEN A=A+2^X
60     NEXT X
70     LPRINT CHR$(A+128);:A=0
80   NEXT Z
90   LPRINT CHR$(27);CHR$(16);CHR$(0);CHR$(0)
100 NEXT V
```

Just insert this in your graphics program and call as a subroutine to print the graphics screen ... the writer of this program says it is very slow.

Also here is a program to dump a graphics screen to the printer for a Riteman printer...

```
10 lprint chr$(27)+"A"+chr$(6)
20 for k=0 to 191 step 7
30   lprint chr$(27)+"X"+chr$(255)+chr$(0)
40   for z=0 to 255
50     lprint chr$(-2*(point(z,k+6)=15) -4*(point(z,k+5)=15)
      -8*(point(z,k+4)=15) -16*(point(z,k+3)=15) -32*(point
        (z,k+2)=15) -64*(point(z,k+1)=15) -128*(point(z,k)=15
          ))
60   next z
70   lprint chr$(8)
80 next k
```

This program will dump the white pixels on any background to the

rewritten
issue 5
Pg 788

Riteman printer. It has a fixed time period to print a graphics display, slightly under 5 minutes. (examples of Riteman graphics dumps are displayed throughout this newsletter)

Contributions to this newsletter are always welcome. Preferably type them on A4 with a good quality ribbon. Anything from software/hardware reviews through to notes on Basic, CP/M, machine code or whatever are acceptable. Send to Don Stanley. Also those of you doing unusual things with your SV eg interfacing with other machinery, lets have a short article on what you are doing and any hints for others considering doing similar things.

**** FILE ALLOCATION TABLE ERRORS IN DISK BASIC ****

The correspondence which has been sent my way on this subject indicates that it is an often met problem. The Auckland users group have written to CDL about it also. CDL have evidently passed the Auckland letter on to SpectraVideo. The following are notes on this topic from various people.

Firstly, you can partially recover the disk by filling it up completely. However not all files will be able to be recovered as at least part of the allocation table will be corrupted. Use the following direct line ..

```
FOR I=1 TO 36:SAVE"1:DUMMY"+CHR$(I+32):NEXT
```

This will eventually cause a DISK FULL error, at that stage you should not get the allocation table error, and should be able to load and backup files. BUT note that some (if not all) of the files may contain garbage.

Secondly, the CP/M format program may contribute to the problem particularly if used in conjunction with the 80 column card. CDL suggest that formatting of disks for BASIC should always be done in WIDTH 40 and using the BASIC, not the CP/M, format program. (But this is no guarantee, I have had the problem occur on disks formatted under BASIC .. ed)

Thirdly, I repeat, make a backup of files, particularly ones you use a lot.

STOP PRESS. I HAVE JUST RECEIVED THE FOLLOWING LETTER FROM CDL.

" Concerning the problem "BAD ALLOCATION TABLE", we have been advised from SPECTRAVIDEO that this problem is caused when you are using the CPM "sysgen" program instead of the DISC BASIC "sysgen.bas" program, so I suggest you follow the steps explained at the beginning of the disk basic manual on formatting and sysgening a disc basic disk .."

Fair enough, but I don't think this is the answer. I know of many people who have been using disks for months with no trouble and then have the problem suddenly occur. They certainly haven't been sysgening under CP/M several months later!!

NEW HARDWARE , SOFTWARE and BOOKS

Scheduled for release about the end of the year is a new expander with dual double sided double density disk drives. (dig the d's!!) This is to be bundled with 3 CP/M programs, and also includes a Centronics Interface. No price yet.

The Graphics Tablet is becoming more available, as is the new expander with either 1 or two disk drives, single sided.

If you've brought your computer recently chances are that you have the MARK2 version of both the 318 and 328. Differences from the earlier machines include a built in modulator, a different colour on the keyboard for the 318, and evidently much smaller circuit boards inside, plus an improved cooling system.

Recent purchasers of disk controllers will find CPM version 2.22 enclosed rather than the earlier version 2.20.

40 new software packages to run under Disk Basic should be available by the time you get this newsletter. A lot are games, but some are educational. Note to, that software is being developed in New Zealand now. There are now a large number of third party software developers overseas, so high quality software should be coming in bulk soon.

As well as the manual being offered by some of our club members there is also the Advanced Basic Users Guide now available up to a point. At this stage Spectravideo have only produced 2000 copies worldwide, so if you want it -- get an order in quick. CDL are also offering a version of the SV Technical Manual, again get an order in with your dealer.

GAMES SCORES

For starters SASA highest score to date 29500 (Don S)

TURBOAT

TETRA H

NINJA

OMAC

SPECTRON

TELEBUNNY

SUPER CROS FORCE

37390 "

256750 Colin Chin

53400 "

25700 (Don S)

8490 (Colin Chin

87810 "

748600 (Deirdre Chin

KUNG FU 15835 (Angela Chin)

Lets hear about your high scores, BE H. EST, maybe we'll have a games freaks king of the Spectra competition one night to check it all out !!!!

NEW HARDWARE & SOFTWARE

EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC
EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC
EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC

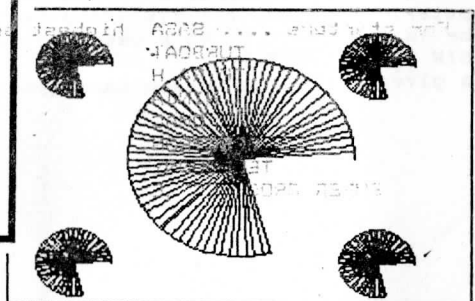
The Graphics Tabies is becoming more available. It is available with either 1 or two disk drives. It is available for CP/M SOFTWARE ... Einsteins have a large range of CP/M software for SPECTRAVIDEO including Basic and Pascal Compilers, Wordstar Peachtext and many others

Recent purchases of disk controllers will run IBM version 2.12. We have in stock the RITEMAN printer some still at pre evaluation prices

40 new software packages for run under Disk Basic should be available by the time you get this newsletter. A lot are games, but some are educational. Most of the software is being developed in New Zealand now. **EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC**
EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC
EINSTEIN SCIENTIFIC

We will be the manual being offered by some of our club members. 177 Willis Street, Wellington for SpectraVideo Hardware, Software and peripherals. There is a point. At this stage SpectraVideo have only produced 10000 because you can't have 20000. call Derek Baker, Raju Bariani, Michael Pollard 851055 for more information. We are also offering a version of the SV Technical Manual. This can be ordered to with your dealer.

RITEMAN
GRAPHIC
EXAMPLES



From Elliott Young here is some information on the PAD command and also using degrees rather than radians. Also, a list of errors so far found in the new Advanced Basic Users Guide.

Program should have the following added to it:
 "AOL and BBS are not reserved words.
 say is completely wrong!
 All of the brands of keys are missing as well as what they
 are. All of the symbols are left out."

PAD

Purpose : Return various status of touch pad.

Format : PAD (n)

Remarks : n ranges from 0 to 3

For $n=0$, the status of the touch pad is returned; -1 when touched, 0 when released.

For n=1, the x co-ordinate is returned, ranging from 0 to 255.

For $n=2$, the y co-ordinate is returned, ranging from 0 to 255.

For $n=3$, the status of the switch on the pad is returned; -1 when pressed, 0 otherwise.

Quite impressive for a new annual, don't you think?

DEGREES

All sines, cosines, etc. on the SpectraVideo are given in radians. This is normal and used for most equations on the computer. However, the time does come when you desire the answer to be in degrees! In this case the following should be used:

SIN (x/57.295781)

This gives the exact answer in degrees.

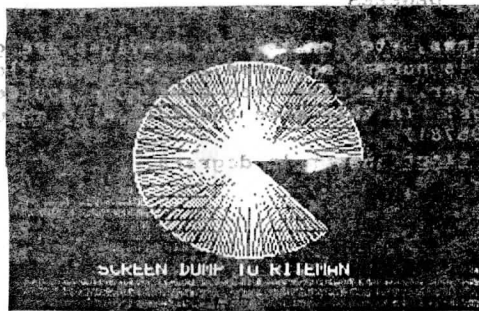
ERRORS IN THE NEW BASIC REFERENCE MANUAL
COMPILED BY ELLIOTT YOUNG

PAGE ERROR

~~~~~

- 012 Some of the symbols are left out.
- 015 2 of the drawings of keys are missing as well as what they say is completely wrong!
- 023 CALL and BASE are not reserved words.
- 062 Program should have the following added to it:  
30 CLICK OFF
- 086 Line 300 should read:  
IF A\$(CHR\$(89) AND A\$(CHR\$(70) THEN GOTO 200
- 089 Line 50 should read:  
IF N<>0 AND N<>1 GOTO 40
- 101 Line 50 should read:  
IF A<B THEN ERROR 08 ELSE IF A>B THEN ERROR 18
- 106 Line 50 should read:  
A=3.14159 \* (R^2)
- 118 Change the following lines:  
40 READ X(K)  
50 PRINT X(K)
- 125 Line 40 should read:  
PRINT A\$;B\$;C\$
- 140 Line 30 should read:  
IF N>100 THEN ERROR 61
- 141 The remarks say that X must be equal to 145.06286085862 when really X can be any number less than that.
- 152 Example should read:  
IF LPOS(0) THEN PRINT CHR\$(13)
- 162 Line 40 should read:  
PRINT X;"L"

Quite impressive for a new manual, don't you think?



REVIEWS #2 + LIBRARY addition  
 and I hope you will find it interesting. The magazine is published monthly and comes with the computer. It is a good idea to have a copy of it which will help you to keep up to date with the latest news in the computer world. It is a good idea to have a copy of it which will help you to keep up to date with the latest news in the computer world.

by Colin Chin

Further to my review on Spectravideo that appeared in issue 1, I would like to thank you for those who wrote completing the missing page numbers. I am pleased to add the following:

**PRACTICAL COMPUTING** - June '84, pages 106-107 on the SV328.  
**AUST/PERSONAL COMPUTING** - April '84, pages 134-143 on both SV18/328 and SV328.

Also, keep an eye on **PERSONAL COMPUTER NEWS** that weekly U.K. that retails for only £1.20 as a regular news item. Both SV and MSX are appearing in its columns. **YOUR COMPUTER** (BENG) also is coming out with some interesting snippets but not every issue. **AMERICAN CREATIVE COMPUTING** has just had a second article on MSX Graphics. I hope you will find it interesting.

Members will have seen the **Deans Whimore** program **SUB HUNT** that appeared in the July issue of **COMPUTER INPUT**. Deans is a member of the Auckland club.

My understanding of **COPYRIGHT** in the context of **COMPUTER INPUT** is that you could be prosecuted in breach of the Act, whereas **Deans** is a lawyer. I am not a lawyer and my opinion is by courtesy of the Wellington Atari Users' Group. We have a J.P. amongst our ranks, but not a lawyer. I don't like a risk by leaving yourself open to a breach!.. (no phone call)

**EASY HOME COMPUTER** is another American magazine with an interest in both SV and MSX. It is published by CBM, Vic-20, Atari and Apple, IBM. When SV has a COMPUTER magazine then we've made it!

**WHICH MICRO**, June '84 issue, contains two SV adverts, a MICROCOM advertising its safe, a Memman-Memory Manipulator and a Morse Decoder for SV328. I am not sure if these are for sale. Also **COMPUTRACE** from West Bank advertising software for SV.

Latest edition to the Club Library is the July '84 issue of **COMPUTER CHOICE** pages 42-45, which contains an article headed

### "Land of the rising MSX"

Although this appears to be the sort of usual article on latest MSX developments that has appeared in a number of English mags, this one is well illustrated - and also has a coloured pic of "MSX Magazine" the Japanese journal for MSX users. Okay, who can read Japanese, and who has got a copy? Also, there's a couple of shots of MSX software and a shop counter that will interest members.

## SPECTRAVIDEO GRAPHICS TABLET REVIEW by Alex Bridger

The Tablet is a neat compact and light unit but does not come with the usual excellent Spectravideo polystyrene packaging. The supplied machine code tape takes 90 seconds to load after which a bright and simple menu comes up, which my 5 year old quickly mastered & enjoyed using - so full marks for user friendliness.

The speed with which you could draw pie charts, bar charts, sawtooth inventory charts and even maps all labelled boxed and coloured was interesting so much faster than preparing them with a program.

The menu offers 13 choices (draw, background, erase, text, boxes, circle, paint, ruler, print, line, csave & cload) plus the 16 colours. As you create your design you flick back and forth between this menu and your picture by pressing the escape key (ESC). The SELECT key is used to choose the desired option, with the cursor being moved in the normal way. The resolution (256x192 pixels corresponding to screen1) & faithfulness of the pad was good but not excellent, some very irritating spikes and aberrations occasionally appeared when you lingered on draw in one spot - fortunately the erase and a re-draw would repair the damage. A medium fast drawing speed was better than slow drawing.

The Tablet's software can only operate in a tape environment presumably a disk version will come later?.

Unfortunately there are problems with the supplied software. Sometimes for a complex drawing it is not possible to save the picture to tape. Another problem with the software meant no hard printed copy was achievable on any printer including the specifically mentioned EPSON printer. (We have developed a screen dump program that solves this problem for printers that can do bit image mapping, can be used with Artist or any other program to get hard copy, if interested send disk or tape plus \$13 for club members (\$3 on ea. sale goes to club) to 11 Mawson St. Lower Hutt with printer name & model plus evng phone no.)

The small manual is the usual crystal clear super brief Spectravideo documentation with some fleeting glimpses given to the more sophisticated user on how to use this tablet under your own program control using the interesting new PAD(i) command.

While the Tablet is a little small for full professional architectural & engineering design uses, it is an economical step in the CAD (computer aided design) direction particularly if coupled with an X-Y plotter. It is very ideal for graphic design where trial and error approaches are needed, & it is useful for educational drawing and design purposes. It may also be useful for designing circuit diagrams and even complicated knitting patterns! (If you are a knitter this is no laughing matter.)

At around \$280 it is an interesting peripheral device which stimulates pictorial creativity & could lead to greater things.

Alterations to program for disk operation and disk data storage:-  
By A. G. Kindell

Cload "file M" from tape but do not run.

List line 1080 and alter with INS Editor to read  
PASTE

SR = 16: SC = 8: COLOR 12: Q8 = "by Greg L. Weinstein":

MA = -1: GOSUB 989: SR = 11: SC = 4: COLOR 15: Q8 =

"Press any key ....": GOSUB 989: MA = 0: COLOR 12:

GOSUB 997: Play "e518c": GOSUB 920: COLOR 10:

Q8 = "Insert your DATA DISK": MA = -1: GOSUB 989 ENTER

List line 3064 and alter with INS Editor the line number  
PASTE  
to line 1150 ENTER

List line 1500 and alter with INS Editor to read  
PASTE

GOSUB 920: SC = 4: SR = 4: Q8 = "Reading diskette ...":

MA = -1: GOSUB 989: LOCATE 0, 255: OPEN "1:SFC" + Q1

FOR INPUT AS 1: INPUT #1 ML, DL, RL, QN: COLOR 1:

LOCATE 20, 10: PRINT "File:" + QN ENTER

List line 3061 and alter as previous

SC = 10: SR = 5: GOSUB 120: GOSUB 996: Q8 = "Place Data Diskette

in drive": GOSUB 989: GOSUB 989 ENTER

List line 3066 and alter as previous

LOCATE 0, 255: OPEN "1:SFC" + Q1 FOR OUTPUT AS 1

Insert formatted blank disk in diskdrive and type:-

SAVE "1:file M" and ENTER

Cload "file G" from tape but do not run.

List line 510 and alter as previous to read

LOCATE 0, 19: PRINT "Ready blank disk to save file" ENTER

List line 530 and alter as previous to read

OPEN "1:SFC" + QN FOR OUTPUT AS 1

Insert your disk on which you saved "file M"

Type SAVE "1:file G" and ENTER

NB: Make sure cursor is before OK prompt when entering

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Alterations to Program (A. G. King)

NATIONAL SV FEDERATION?

The offer of Computer Distributors Ltd to meet the Club, on the Monday following the "Bits & Bytes" Computer Show, highlighted the weekend of August 31-September 2.

Peter de Zwart, Product Manager of GDL met a small group of members able to attend. Mr de Zwart was careful to outline CDL's policy towards SV Users which was mostly governed by the various agreements between Spectra Video International Ltd and the N.Z. distributors, viz. Computer Distributors Ltd, a subsidiary of the Consolidated Enterprises Ltd.

Mr de Zwart promised a lot of future software for the local Users. In particular, dealers had already been advised of three new games which were now available. These being "Bomb New York", "Swing Man" and "an old favourite" "Othello".

A new Expander Unit, SV305B was also to be shortly available. This was to be aimed at the small business market rather than the home user.

The small SV portable had been ordered and CDL had not been advised at the expected time of deliveries. (This is somewhat in contrast with comments appearing in the latest issues of YOUR COMPUTER and PERSONAL COMPUTER NEWS. Both English publications which are now available from local bookstands.

Some questions were also raised on the new Bondwell H4 and 12 machines which were also compatible with the SV318 and SV328. Bondwell are the actual holding company of SV International.

#### MSX MACHINES

The only MSX machine expected to be available on the local market will be the Sanyo MPC. (This confirms the latest article to appear in YOUR COMPUTER AS TO THE FACT THAT THE ONLY MSX MACHINE TO BE AVAILABLE ON THE LOCAL MARKET WILL BE THE SANYO MPC.)

The difficulties facing N.Z. Users are that all cartridges require Import Licenses under the category of "Toys". All licenses in this category are very tightly held, so that neither CDL nor another importer such as Fortuna who were expected to market the "Pencil" were unable to do so.

The added problem was that MSX were only producing the basic hardware, and the only software available in Japan were Games cartridges. Furthermore, these were not actually compatible with the SVs. However, SVI had overcome this problem with the availability of the MSX adapter, towards the end of 1984.

Mr de Zwart also gave a personal opinion that he was not sure that MSX would catch on in N.Z. Judging by the reports emerging from the USA, this could well be, but there are a lot of conflicting commercial events occurring in Europe that could alter this viewpoint. Already, an English PC known as "The Rabbit" is reported to be seeking membership of the MSX group.

## NATIONAL SV FEDERATION?

And just look at the June '84 issue of COMPUTER & VIDEO GAMES (Page 149) where two leading Japanese software companies have already switched production from Arcade games to MSX games. The two companies being Konami who have already have FROGGER, TIME PILOT, SUPER COBRA and a new big seller - ANTARCTIC ADVENTURE - available from MSX cartridges. The other producer being Namco, who are already famous for PAC MAN, POLE POSITION, DIG DUG, MAPPY, GALAXIAN. With a shortage of cartridges, Namco are struggling to keep up demand whilst Konami with 20 MSX cartridges on the market, everything is pointing towards the importation of MSX adapters and private trips to Japan, by New Zealanders.

One new product on display at the show, courtesy of CDL was the long awaited SVI 05 Graphics Tablet. This will retail at \$295, and uses only a ballpoint pen to create the actual graphics. An instruction to the Printer will produce a hard copy. This product is actually different from the actual illustrated example which appeared in the coloured brochures.

It is expected that BITS & BYTES will shortly be previewing this Graphics Tablet, in their regular SV column. A new book, the SVI 05 Graphics Tablet, which is a new addition to the SVI 05 series, is now being produced. The future of SVI software looks more than just promising. Already, a list of 40 new titles from overseas have been promised by SVI to CDL, and this information is already in the hands of the N.Z. dealers.

In addition, the recent SV Competition, run by the CDL had attracted 35 entries. The winning entries had now been forwarded to SVI in Hong Kong for appraisal, and hopefully a potential export earner.

## COMPETITION WINNERS

- 1st : "The Internal Combustion Engine" from New Plymouth Callender (New Plymouth)
- 2nd : "Sound Editor" from T Cooper (Auckland)
- 3rd : "Intergraph" from J. Kelly (Auckland)
- 4th : "Quickdraw" from Peter George (Oamaru)
- 5th : "Galactic Recovery" from W Rutherford (New Plymouth)

According to CDL, there was only one entry from Wellington.

The winning entry was actually displayed on Moonshine's stand on the Saturday, for those fortunate enough to see it. And despite the title, it ideally was a graphic support to INTRODUCTION TO BASIC, and a wonderful intro. to the SV capabilities. In fact, the judges stated that it "excelled in presentation".

CDL, will in future, only market the software provided by

## NATIONAL SV FEDERATION?

SVI. (In the main, all these will probably be in Machine Code). Local software, will be handled by Alpine Computing Ltd, whereas another Oamaru company, Kiwi Soft, is working on a series of Educational software.

Two events of a national milestone also surfaced at this meeting. A Dunedin-based dealer who had produced a Newsletter, had now turned out a monthly magazine called KIWI-MSX. Subscriptions were \$10.00 p.a.

## NATIONAL SV FEDERATION

Mr de Zwart emphasised that the time had probably arrived for the formation of a Federation of User Groups, so that a communication be set up between CDLs (the Distributors) and the consumer (User Groups). He already had the approval of the Auckland group to approach their Wellington counterparts.

This idea can be backed by the judging of the recent SV software competition, when CDL invited a Committee member of the Auckland User Club to join the Judging Panel. The Auckland User Group have just been in touch with Don, who will report to the next meeting on latest developments on formation of the Federation.

Two new manuals were also produced at the meeting. These were a new Technical Manual, prepared by CDL, as well as the new BASIC REFERENCE MANUAL (SVI-318/328-BRM) which had been airfreighted from SVI in Hong Kong. They were priced at \$14.95 and \$24.95 respectively. The former is in a cyclostyled form, with the latter printed half A3 covering 366 pages; now available from dealers. Two copies of each had been ordered by Don Stanley, on behalf of the club.

The production of these, especially the latter emphasised the duplication of research efforts, which could be avoided by the formation of a Federation.

Already, there are clubs in Auckland, Wellington, Napier, New Plymouth and Oamaru. And it now appears as if Masterton and Christchurch could be next. CDL had advised that over 1200 SVs now had been sold in NZ, which placed Spectravideo now the 2nd best selling computer on the local scene.

A final gesture from the CDL meeting was their offer of prizes for any competitions held by the club.

## BITS &amp; BYTES SHOW

Leading the way to the consumer on Moonshine Computers' stand was the very expensive cartridge ALPHA SECTOR which retails at \$129.95.

The apparent price was due to the 150k of EPROM in this brightly lit game.

## NATIONAL SV FEDERATION?

Don Stanley spotted on the Philips Electrical stand - the ultimate viz. THE LAST ONE, a software package that can design any program at \$150.00 (there is also a \$1200 version). For a loan of a SV system, the dealer said this could be available (converted) for the SV.

Latest we hear on this subject is that TLO is only available for CP/M3.0 series, which we understand from CDL is what is being developed by SVI.

The price of discs also varied. Moonshine had packs of 10 at \$57.50, whereas Dick Smith Electronics at \$64.50.

DICK SMITH were on show in Wellington, for the first time. They are to open in Renouf House, Featherston Street on October 1. However, the big disappointment was that none of their displayed goods were for sale. If this was a flag flying exercise, then this lack of effort may just be not the start they wanted, especially with the huge rentals payable (\$52000 p.a.). The author saw \$1.00 Dick Smith catalogues disappearing, when none of the goods could be sold before Sunday night.

Dick Smith had a couple of interesting Printer Plotters. The VZ200 at \$495 and another TP version at \$595. (The author had a SV with him, and managed to operate the TP version without any hitches. The Dick Smith version did not shake hands so well.) Another printer plotter was the JP-831 on Moonshine's stand was retailed at \$395. Unfortunately, the demo disc and manual were all written in Applesoft basic, and couldn't be run with the SV without conversion at time of writing.

Bell's Tech Books was disappointed. The author was looking for something on Applesoft basic, and everything was well over the \$25 mark. Whitcoulls were likewise. Basic titles such as Osborne's MACHINE CODE were notably unavailable, as was Ian Sinclair's SPECTRAVIDEO COMPUTING.

In fact, Moonshine were the only stand that had the book available. If members are unable to obtain a copy at \$24.95, then contact either COASTLANDS BOOKSHOPS, MASTERTON COMPUTERS, or SOUTH AUCKLAND COMPUTERS, all of whom support the Club, and both still have copies left at time of writing. The NZ distributors, Collins Publishers (NZ) Ltd of Auckland, no longer have any copies, whereas CDL also obtained a limited number for SV dealers. No more are expected to be available for at least 3 months, and the expected thoughts are that the U.K. may be sold out too. Apparently, only 2000 copies were imported.

PC85

It has been announced in Auckland, that another Bits & Bytes Computer Show has already been scheduled next May. This will be known as PC85, and will be held at the Overseas Terminal, Auckland between May 8 and 12, 1985.

Note the emphasis being placed on "Personal Computers". This show is being organised jointly between "Bits & Bytes" and Communications Company of Auckland.

A feature of the show will be seminars to be presented by leading local and overseas experts who will examine the micro industry trends in both hardware and software. These will also focus on market trends, industry incentives and sales tax - problems that occur on the N.Z. scene.

## Moonshine Computers

### Stocktaking Specials

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| SV 801 Disc Controller     | 295   | 255 |
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| SV 602 Mini Expander       | 60    | 50  |
| SD 255 Nomis Game          | 18    | 10  |
| SD 288 Spectra type        | 18    | 10  |
| SD 903 Grave yard          | 18    | 12  |
| SD 904 Gobbler             | 18    | 12  |
| SD Textprint               | 25    | 20  |
| SD 294 Justwrite Cartridge | 79.95 | 70  |

### All prices are net Cash

Super Saver Drives in case to suit 328 or 318 = \$ 525

Phone Ren 739-146 or Peter 697-757

Shop 13 70 Victoria St

McDonalds Centre Lower Hutt

Herbert St \*Limited No of SV1 Basic

City Reference manuals \$24.95

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